



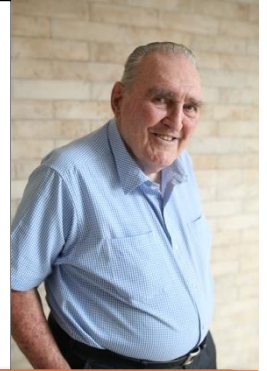
The Garamut "The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL
PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions

No. 31. 31st August 2026



**OUR THEME: THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN BELIEF AND PRACTICE.
THE GAP BETWEEN IDEALISM AND REALITY.
BETWEEN THEORY AND PRACTICE.**

IT IS IN THIS ARENA THAT IDEALS CLASH WITH REALITY.

WHERE IDEALISM AND BELIEF ARE CONFRONTED AND REALITY AND PRACTICE ARE CONTRASTED.

IT IS WHERE OUR VALUES AND INTENTIONS ARE RIGHT AND PURE BUT OUR PERFORMANCE IN CARRYING THEM OUT IS EXPOSED TO CONFLICT, DIFFICULTY AND TO THOSE DISTRACTING ELEMENTS OF NORMAL DAILY LIVING.

THIS GAP BETWEEN WHAT WE BELIEVE AND WHAT WE DO IS UNIVERSALLY EXPERIENCED BY ALL MANKIND.

BELIEFS ARE EASY BECAUSE THEY PRESENT NO FRICTION AND LITTLE SACRIFICE AND ON PAPER ANY IDEAL ADVOCATES IT WILL WORK.

BUT BELIEFS LIVE IN A VACUUM AND THEY DO NOT GET TIRED NOR DO THEY REVEAL THE PRACTICALITIES REQUIRED FOR THEM TO BECOME REALITY.

IDEALISM MAY GIVE US A VISION FOR A BETTER WORLD OR A BETTER SELF TO BE REACHED AND ACTS AS A MORAL COMPASS, BUT A COMPASS IS ONLY A TOOL THAT POINTS TOWARDS THE OBJECTIVE.

IT DOES NOT CLEAR THE WEEDS THAT SEEK TO CHOKER OR DRAIN AWAY ALL THE SUSTENANCE OF OUR RESOLVE OR CLIMB THE HURDLES AND MOUNTAINS FOR US.

■ **PRACTICE ENCOUNTERS THE FRICTION OF APPLICATION.**

THE MOMENT YOU TRY TO LIVE OUT A BELIEF AND SEEK TO MAKE IT A REALITY, THE WORLD, THE DEVIL PUSHES BACK.

CONSIDER THE CHURCH OR THE INDIVIDUAL WHO CREATES A "MISSION STATEMENT" FILLED WITH POSITIVE AND SINCERE WORDS LIKE *COMPASSION, EMPATHY, FAMILY, NATIONS, ACCOUNTABILITY AND SUSTAINABILITY*.

THESE ARE VISIONARY ASPECTS THAT IS GENUINELY BELIEVED; BUT THE PRACTICE – THE IMPLEMENTATION IS GOVERNED BY OTHER FACTORS. SUCH AS AVAILABILITY OF PERSONNEL, FINANCES, IMMEDIATE OPPORTUNITIES.

■ **EXAMPLE: THIS HAPPENS ON AN INDIVIDUAL LEVEL.**

- WHERE WE BELIEVE IN HONESTY, BUT WE SOMETIMES DON'T REVEAL ALL THE TRUTH ABOUT A SPECIFIC MATTER OR TELL A, "LITTLE WHITE LIE".
- WHERE WE OFTEN AVOID HAVING AN AWKWARD CONVERSATION THAT IS NEEDED TO BRING ABOUT SOME CHANGE IN PEOPLE.
- WHERE WE BELIEVE IN HELPING THE POOR BUT WALK PAST THE HOMELESS MAN BECAUSE WE ARE TOO BUSY TO DO SOMETHING OR GET TO SOMEWHERE.
- THIS IS NOT BECAUSE WE ARE EVIL, BUT BECAUSE REALITY FORCES US TO MAKE COMPROMISES IN REAL-TIME.

■ **CLOSING THE GAP WITHOUT GIVING UP**

- THE EFFECT OF REALIZING THAT THIS GAP EXISTS, CAN CAUSE US TO BE DISCOURAGED AND WANT TO GIVE UP.

- BUT THE GAP BETWEEN IDEALISM AND REALITY IS NOT ALWAYS A SIGN OF FAILURE; BUT ONE OF BEING HUMAN.
- THE GOAL OF HAVING HIGH IDEALS IS NOT TO REACH PERFECTION, BUT TO HAVE SOMETHING WORTH AIMING FOR.
- IF WE WANT TO BRIDGE THE GAP, WE HAVE TO STOP TREATING OUR BELIEFS LIKE FRAGILE GLASS ORNAMENTS THAT SHATTER AT THE FIRST MISTAKE. INSTEAD, WE NEED TO TREAT THEM LIKE MUSCLES. THEY GET TIRED AND FAIL UNDER HEAVY LOADS, BUT THEY GET STRONGER THE MORE WE EXERCISE THEM.
- PRACTICE DOESN'T MAKE PERFECT; IT JUST MAKES US A LITTLE MORE HONEST ABOUT THE REALITY OF THE STRUGGLE.
- THERE IS A DESPERATE NEED FOR THE FOLLOWERS OF CHRIST TO BRIDGE THE GAP.
- THE GAP BETWEEN WHAT IS BELIEVED AND WHAT IS PRACTICED.
- BETWEEN WHAT IS PROFESSED AND WHAT IS ACTUALLY POSSESSED.

■ THE RELEVANCE AND RELIABILITY OF FAITH.

- FAITH MUST BE SEEN THAT IT HAS RELEVANCE, RELIABILITY AND EFFECTIVENESS IN DEALING WITH TODAY'S NEEDS – OURS AND THE MINISTRY NEEDS OF OTHERS.
- HAVE WE TRIED FAITH (TRUSTING GOD) AS A CREDIBLE OPTION – TO ALL THOSE OTHER THINGS THAT THIS PRESENT WORLD SYSTEMS OFFER?
- ARE WE PRACTICING THE INTRODUCTION OF FAITH AND TRUST IN GOD?
- AS WE ENDEAVOUR TO ADDRESS THE CRISIS AND CHALLENGES OF LIFE THAT WE ARE EXPERIENCING FROM DAY TO DAY.

■ THE PRACTICING OF FAITH IS TO BE OUR FIRST OPTION NOT THE LAST.

- DO WE PRACTICE INTRODUCING FAITH, (TRUST IN GOD) INTO OUR ENDEAVOURS TO ADDRESS THE CRISIS AND CHALLENGES OF LIFE THAT WE FACE AND OTHERS FACE?
- FAITH STILL HAS RELEVANCE AND EFFECTIVENESS WHEN FACING THE STORMS AND TRIALS OF LIFE AND SHOULD NEVER BE OMITTED (LEFT OUT).
- The INTEGRITY, WORTH and EFFECTIVENESS of PRACTICAL LIVING FAITH – FAITH THAT LEADS TO CORRESPONDING ACTS can never be questioned as it is supported again and again throughout Scripture.
- IT IS GOD'S METHOD.

■ THE PRESENCE AND PRACTICE OF FAITH.

- GOD'S WORD SAYS THAT PERSONAL FAITH IS ALWAYS NEEDED AT ALL TIMES ESPECIALLY IN FACING LIFE'S CIRCUMSTANCES.
- IT MUST BE BOTH PRESENT AND PRACTICED.
- FAITH WITHOUT CORRESPONDING WORKS IS DESCRIBED AS BEING USELESS – CONTRIBUTING NOTHING – INEFFECTIVE – DEAD.

James 2:17 so you see, faith by itself isn't enough. Unless it produces good deeds, it is dead and useless. NLT
James 2:20 do you want to be shown, you foolish person, that faith apart from works is useless? ESV

- THERE MUST BE MORE THAN MERE PROFESSION, THERE MUST ALSO BE PERFORMANCE THAT RESULTS IN TAKING POSSESSION OF WHAT YOU BELIEVED FOR.

■ GOD'S PART AND MAN'S EFFORTS.

- GOD DID NOT GROW THINGS – HE PROVIDED MAN WITH THE SEED, THE SOIL, THE WATER AND THE SUN – THEN ASKED MAN TO PREPARE THE SOIL, PLANT THE SEED, WATER IT AND GOD GIVES THE INCREASE (HARVEST).
- WITHOUT GOD MAN CANNOT AND WITHOUT MAN GOD CANNOT.
- GOD PROVIDED THE GOSPEL THAT'S HIS PART, BUT MAN'S PART IS TO PROCLAIM IT.
- MAN COULDN'T PROVIDE THE GOSPEL AND GOD WON'T DO MAN'S JOB OF PROCLAIMING IT.
- FAITH AND BELIEVING IS OUR PART AND MAKING IT HAPPEN IS GOD'S PART.

- LET US HAVE IDEALS AND VISION AND GOOD THOUGHTS ABOUT THE FUTURE BUT LET IT LEAD TO PRACTICE – SOMETHING THAT HAS SUBSTANCE – HANDS AND FEET ETC.

Amen! Ps Barry